

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥ Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣ 7

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6 ♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦ J

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6 ♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣ J

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥ 3

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6
 ♥ 9 3
 ♦ A K 10 9 3
 ♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A K Q 10 3

♥ A K 6

♦ 8 6

♣ A Q 4



♠ 8 7 5
 ♥ Q J 10 4
 ♦ Q 5 4
 ♣ 10 8 5

♠ J 4 2

♥ 8 7 5 2

♦ J 7 2

♣ K 6 3

SOUTH has 5 points, so she responds 2♦ to NORTH's opening 2♣ bid.

NORTH bids his 5-card ♠ suit.

SOUTH is too good for the second negative, so she supports NORTH's ♠.

NORTH doesn't have enough to think about slam, so he signs off at 4♠.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♥Q			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q
♥ K Q J 2
♦ A Q 9 8
♣ A K 4

♠ 10 8 5 4 3

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K 10

♣ 10 9 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 7 2

♥ A 7 5

♦ J 4 2

♣ 6 5 3

♠ 9 6

♥ 9 6 4

♦ 7 6 5 3

♣ Q J 8 7

West

2♣

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

Lead: ♣7

North

Pass

East

2NT

South

Pass

WEST opens 2♣ with her balanced 25 points.

EAST has 9 points but no 5-card suit. He should make a positive response of 2NT.

WEST figures EAST for 8 points and bids 6NT. If EAST has significantly more than 8 it will be up to him to go to 7NT. But he doesn't.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 4 3

♥ 6

♦ J 10 7 4

♣ J 10 9 6 5

♠ K Q J 8 2

♥ A 5

♦ A K 2

♣ A K 2



♠ A 9 6 5

♥ 10 9 7 4

♦ Q 5 3

♣ Q 3

♠ 7

♥ K Q J 8 3 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 8 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♦ J

NORTH opens 2♣ and SOUTH, with 8 points should bid 2♥.

NORTH should bid his ♠ suit at his second turn.

And SOUTH can only rebid the 6-card ♥s.

That's enough for NORTH to hear. He bids 6♥, or, just as good, he might bid 6NT.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 5

♥ 8 5

♦ Q 7 2

♣ K Q 5 3

♠ 3

♥ J 10 6 3

♦ 9 8 4

♣ J 10 8 4 2



♠ K Q 8 7

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A K J 6

♣ 6

♠ 9 6 4 2

♥ 9 7 4

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A 9 7

After EAST's 2♣ opening, WEST bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. WEST actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

EAST's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking WEST for a 4-card Major. WEST mentions his ♠s and EAST bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now WEST adds his 12 points to EAST's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			
6♠ by West			
Lead: ♣J			

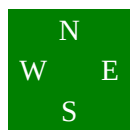
Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 5 4
♥ 8 4
♦ A K J 3
♣ J 8 5 2

♠ A K Q 6 3
♥ A K 10 9 6
♦ 10 6
♣ A



♠ 10 9 8 7
♥ 7 3
♦ Q 5 4
♣ K Q 9 4

♠ 2
♥ Q J 5 2
♦ 9 8 7 2
♣ 10 7 6 3

SOUTH has 3 points, so she responds 2♦ to NORTH's opening 2♣ bid, then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when NORTH bids 2♠.

However, when NORTH then bids ♥s, SOUTH finds two more points and bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♥3			